

Chapter 50: Face-Off

With a light tap of her finger, Yan Lin had spent over a hundred thousand yuan, but she herself didn't seem to care much. Even after sending ten carnivals, she quietly typed a message.

[I'm not a child, no need to worry.]

Feng Yue was somewhat helpless. "Whether you're a child or not, there's no need to send gifts. This is clearly a fan benefit - there's no reason to make everyone spend money."

The netizens probably had never seen a streamer who desperately refused gifts from everyone. Their rebellious psychology was starting to kick in - you send a small rose, I'll send some cat food. This made Feng Yue quite helpless, and she could only thank everyone one by one.

It wasn't that she was angry - everyone's willingness to send her gifts was also a form of affection. She just personally felt there was no need for everyone to spend money like this.

Meanwhile, Yan Lin, holed up in the adjacent private room, felt a surge of possessiveness when she heard Feng Yue mention other people's IDs one by one.

Another fifty carnivals were sent out.

Fu Sixue watched the entire process from the side, only able to shake her head in pity. Her friend was probably beyond saving.

The audience, who had just experienced the shock of ten carnivals, were again stunned speechless by these fifty carnivals.

So was this really some big shot's alternate account coming here to watch a fan benefit livestream?

Seeing this, Feng Yue also felt something was off. "This friend, you really don't need to keep sending gifts. Five hundred thousand yuan isn't pocket change - there's no need to keep giving me gifts like this."

[I have money.]

Feng Yue: "..."

Unable to stop the other person, Feng Yue could only sigh and stop mentioning it. However, she secretly decided that after the livestream ended, she would withdraw the streaming revenue from the backend and transfer it to this netizen.

This was just a small interlude during the livestream. The main purpose of Feng Yue's livestream today was still to taste-test Wen Zhen's new dishes.

After chatting with fans for a while longer, Wen Zhen finally appeared pushing a cart full of dishes.

Wen Zhen knew very well that her identity would cause trouble for Feng Yue, so the two had agreed beforehand that she wouldn't appear on camera.

"Sorry for the wait." Wen Zhen said as she arranged the dishes she had personally prepared on the table.

"All our dishes are ready. Let me show everyone first." Feng Yue picked up her phone and showed everyone the five dishes arranged on the table.

Steamed golden pomfret with preserved plums, lobster baked in superior stock, crispy roasted pigeon, pan-fried silky tofu, and salt and pepper crab with golden sand¹ - these five dishes were all new items the restaurant would launch at the end of the year.

These Cantonese dishes were already famous, but Wen Zhen had added some of her own research and techniques to the original recipes. Today, Feng Yue was her taste tester.

Wen Zhen's appearance was within Yan Lin's expectations, but she was also annoyed by this expected event. In her annoyance, she sent out another fifty carnivals, hoping to draw Feng Yue's attention.

Including the gifts sent earlier, she had now cumulatively sent out one million yuan worth of gifts.

Now the livestream fans were even more restless. Someone screenshot this and posted it on Weibo, and this kind of big-spending behavior naturally caught the attention of marketing accounts.

Once the marketing accounts posted about it, more netizens flooded into Feng Yue's livestream to watch the excitement.

[Coming to take a photo with the million-yuan big shot.]

[Let me see what kind of streamer can make a tycoon spend freely.]

[The livestream only has this many people - could this be staged publicity?]

The abnormality in the livestream naturally caught Feng Yue's attention. She had just been filming the dishes on the table, so she missed Yan Lin's gift-sending. Only now, after everyone mentioned it, did she learn that the 998 netizen had sent her another fifty carnivals.

Seeing Feng Yue's furrowed brow, Wen Zhen asked, "What's wrong? Is there trouble in the livestream?"

Feng Yue quietly explained the situation to Wen Zhen, and a complex, indecipherable glint flashed in Wen Zhen's eyes.

She was certain that this user 99899811 must be someone Feng Yue knew, and very likely Feng Yue's ex-wife.

However, this was just her speculation, and she couldn't tell Feng Yue directly. So she suggested, "How about this - go to the backend and turn off the gift-receiving option. That way no one can send you gifts."

"That's possible!" Feng Yue wasn't familiar with these things, so hearing Wen Zhen's suggestion, she prepared to pick up her phone and turn it off.

The two were speaking without avoiding the livestream viewers, so Yan Lin naturally heard their entire conversation clearly.

She hurriedly sent out another fifty carnivals with a message: **[Don't turn it off!]**

Feng Yue naturally saw her message, but only said, "Since I didn't know the gift option could be turned off, everyone spent money unnecessarily before. Let's just focus on streaming properly from now on. Friend 998, you've really sent too much. I'll contact you after the livestream ends."

After saying this, she stopped mentioning gifts and focused on doing her mukbang for everyone.

Yan Lin: "..."

Fu Sixue naturally heard every word Feng Yue said, and she almost laughed out loud at Yan Lin's self-inflicted outcome.

However, as Yan Lin's friend, she still comforted her with a few words. "Alright, alright, if you can't send gifts then don't. Just watch Moon's livestream properly."

Yan Lin didn't speak, only feeling that she had lost another round to Wen Zhen.

"Do you want to order some more food? You barely ate anything just now. Why don't you order some dishes to go with watching Moon's livestream?"

Yan Lin nodded.

Fu Sixue understood, naturally knowing that Yan Lin, who was glued to Feng Yue's livestream, wouldn't possibly go out to call a server herself, so she had to go out.

Since it was busy time at the restaurant, Fu Sixue couldn't find any available servers after searching around outside. She had to wait outside for a while before leading a server back to their private room.

However, by sheer coincidence, just as she walked into the corridor where the private rooms were, she saw Wen Zhen pushing open the door and coming out of Feng Yue's private room.

The two locked eyes directly.

Fu Sixue had always maintained a somewhat appreciative attitude toward Wen Zhen, so seeing her now, there was no reason not to greet her.

"Boss Wen, long time no see." She smiled sweetly, revealing a small canine tooth on one side, making her whole person look harmless and innocent.

Wen Zhen didn't particularly like this seemingly harmless Miss Fu, so she also smiled politely. "Miss Fu, long time no see."

Since Fu Sixue was here, it meant Yan Lin might also be around. Thinking this, Wen Zhen's gaze unconsciously glanced toward the tightly closed door of the adjacent private room.

Fu Sixue naturally noticed her gaze and stepped slightly to the side to block it, pretending to ask curiously, "Boss Wen, is there something you're looking at?"

Wen Zhen withdrew her gaze. "Nothing. I still have matters to attend to, so I won't chat more with Miss Fu. Enjoy your meal."

"Take care, Boss Wen." Fu Sixue watched her figure until she left, then turned and entered the private room.

Feng Yue's livestream didn't last too long - after all, she couldn't keep eating one meal forever. After streaming for about an hour, Feng Yue said goodbye to everyone.

After the livestream ended, Feng Yue didn't leave immediately but chatted with Wen Zhen about those dishes.

The two had a pleasant conversation, as if the month-long separation had never happened.

Feng Yue felt relieved.

"By the way, the person who sent you gifts in the livestream - do you know them?" Wen Zhen asked.

Mentioning this person, Feng Yue frowned again. "I don't know them. I just checked and it looks like a zombie account. I sent them a private message saying I wanted to refund the money, but they didn't reply."

"A zombie account? I feel like it's more like an alternate account. If it wasn't someone you know, they probably wouldn't send you so many gifts. You could post on your social media to ask around." Wen Zhen suggested appropriately.

She was already quite certain about this person's identity, and with just encountering Fu Sixue outside, the possibility that the gift-sender was Yan Lin had directly shot up to 99%.

However, Wen Zhen had no evidence, so she didn't tell Feng Yue directly, instead letting Feng Yue figure it out herself.

Sure enough, after hearing Wen Zhen's words, Feng Yue vaguely had some suspicions, but without evidence, she didn't dare jump to conclusions.

However, if that person really was Yan Lin, Feng Yue only felt the other party was extremely boring!

It was getting late, and Wen Zhen still had to stay at the restaurant to handle the new signage matter, so she didn't personally send Feng Yue home but arranged a car for her.

The driver quickly arrived at the restaurant entrance, and the two got up to leave. Just as they left, the two people in the adjacent private room also got up to leave.

As soon as Fu Sixue and Yan Lin left their private room, they saw the two people walking side by side not far ahead. Yan Lin was holding her phone, with the interface showing her alternate account's private chat with Feng Yue.

She stared straight at the two people ahead, somewhat lost in thought. It was precisely in this moment of inattention that a server carrying a bowl of leftover soup suddenly emerged from around the corner.

The server crashed straight into Yan Lin, spilling all the remaining soup onto her wool coat, with the hem still dripping.

Yan Lin immediately snapped back to attention, her tightly furrowed brows indicating her current displeasure.

"I'm so sorry, so sorry!" The server was shocked. With just one look, she knew this was definitely clothing she couldn't afford to compensate for. "I'm truly very sorry! I didn't see you coming!"

Several nearby servers quickly rushed over - some hurried to notify the manager, while others brought clean towels for Yan Lin.

The commotion drew Wen Zhen's attention from ahead. She turned around and immediately saw Yan Lin and Fu Sixue surrounded by people.

Seeing Wen Zhen stop, Feng Yue also curiously looked back, then directly met Yan Lin's familiar eyes.

Yan Lin held her phone in one hand, keeping it safe. Feng Yue's gaze moved from her to the bright phone screen.

The two weren't far apart, and Feng Yue could roughly make out the information on the screen. If she wasn't mistaken, the image on Yan Lin's phone screen was the backend revenue screenshot she had taken and sent to user 99899811 not long ago.

Noticing Feng Yue's gaze, Yan Lin hurriedly turned off her phone screen, not daring to look at Feng Yue anymore.

She lowered her eyes to look at her oil-stained coat, truly not having expected such an accident.

Fu Sixue took in both their expressions completely, not even missing the flash of regret in Yan Lin's eyes.

This wasn't a place for conversation - it was better to deal with Ah Lin's immediate trouble first.

Thinking this, Fu Sixue quickly helped wipe the dirty areas with a towel.

The manager arrived late, immediately giving the server a thorough scolding with quite harsh language.

Neither Yan Lin nor Fu Sixue could bear to listen to such words, so Yan Lin frowned and stopped them. "Stop scolding her. You don't need to compensate."

Although it was indeed the server who bumped into her, if she hadn't been so lost in thought, she should have been able to avoid it.

Wen Zhen stood not far away, glanced at Feng Yue's expression beside her, then stepped toward Yan Lin.

"Miss Yan's loss today will be compensated by me personally. After all, as the boss, I didn't train my staff properly." Wen Zhen didn't want to owe Yan Lin anything, and gestured for the manager to take the server away first.

The servers dispersed, leaving only the four of them.

"No need." Yan Lin looked at her coldly. "Boss Wen and I can be considered acquaintances. There's no need to fuss over such a small matter."

"That won't do. This is my gesture of goodwill - I hope Miss Yan won't refuse."

Yan Lin wanted to refuse, but Fu Sixue pressed her hand and said, "Ah Lin, Boss Wen has good intentions. Just accept it. Friends should give and take - I think Boss Wen means the same thing."

Yan Lin and Wen Zhen both thought: Who wants to be friends with her!

Both looked frustrated and choked up.

But since Wen Zhen insisted on compensating, she couldn't go back on her word now. She forced a smile. "Miss Fu is right. In that case, I'll have someone deliver new clothing to Yan Corporation tomorrow."

Yan Lin coldly responded, "Mm."

After resolving this matter, Yan Lin turned her gaze to Feng Yue. Meeting Feng Yue today was unexpected for Yan Lin. Although she had come to Wen Zhen's restaurant, she truly hadn't thought about seeing Feng Yue.

"Ah Yue..."

"Yan Lin, is it fun to toy with me?" Feng Yue looked steadily at Yan Lin's dark eyes, her voice quite calm.

"I didn't..." Yan Lin instinctively wanted to deny it.

But Feng Yue held up her phone, clearly showing the private chat interface with that 998 user. "You didn't? Can you still say you didn't after seeing this interface?"

Yan Lin fell silent, then looked up and admitted what she had done. "I admit that person is me, but I didn't mean to toy with you."

"Using an alternate account to send millions of yuan worth of gifts in my livestream, continuing to send them even after I stopped you several times - and you still say you weren't toying with me."

What, CEO Yan couldn't find other places to display your wealth? Did hearing me thank you over and over again feel good?" Feng Yue felt completely humiliated, as if she had been played. Just thinking about how she had smiled sweetly while thanking Yan Lin on camera made her feel wronged.

Seeing Feng Yue's slightly reddened eyes, Yan Lin immediately felt flustered and explained frantically, "Ah Yue... I didn't mean it like that..."

But Feng Yue didn't wait for her to finish. Those slightly red eyes stared directly at Yan Lin, her words like a poisoned dagger stabbing straight into Yan Lin's heart.

"Yan Lin, you really disgust me."

Footnotes:

¹ **Golden sand (金沙)** - A Cantonese cooking technique where ingredients (often egg yolks) are prepared to resemble golden sand, typically used as a coating or garnish